

U.S. HISTORY HACK™

Teacher Graphic Organizer Toolkit

Unit 1 — The Rise of Industrialization (1877–1900) • Reproducible

WHY THIS TOOLKIT

Knowing WHICH organizer to use, and WHEN, is half the battle. This toolkit tells you — with a brief why for each — then gives you reproducible blanks (Part 1) and per-standard Cornell support backs (Part 2). Tennessee connections are highlighted throughout; the local-to-national move is a HistoryHack signature and a point of difference for our classrooms.

Which Organizer, When — Quick Guide

Scan the left column for what the activity asks students to do; reach for the organizer on the right. Every organizer in Part 1 also carries its own “when to use · why it works” note.

When the task asks students to...	Reach for...	Why it works
compare / contrast TWO things	Venn (2) or T-Chart	Marzano's highest-yield strategy; the overlap names shared traits
compare 3+ things on set criteria	Compare & Contrast Matrix	systematic; lowers cognitive load
explain causes / effects	Cause & Effect	makes causal chains visible (SSP.05)
put events in order / show change	Timeline / Sequence	builds chronological reasoning (SSP.05)
brainstorm or connect ideas	Concept Web	activates prior knowledge; shows relationships
summarize a text or source	Main Idea & Details	separates the central idea from support
activate prior knowledge & track learning	KWL	metacognition; frames inquiry
learn a key term deeply	Frayer	deep vocabulary processing
analyze a primary source	HIPPO / OPTIC	disciplinary sourcing (SSP.01–02)
make and defend a claim	CER	claim + evidence + reasoning (SSP.04)
weigh two sides / a decision	T-Chart or Problem–Solution	structures evaluation
capture the basics of an event	5 Ws	ensures full coverage
connect a national event to Tennessee	★ Tennessee Connection	our signature local-to-national move

Reproducible — you may copy these pages for classroom use.

Part 1 — Reusable Blank Organizers (all subjects, all units)

Content-agnostic blanks. Print as many as you need; use across any standard or subject.

Task says “compare,” “contrast,” “how are they alike/different?” for TWO things. Marzano’s #1 strategy (identifying similarities & differences). The shared column forces students to name what overlaps, not just list traits.

[illegible]

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one

factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Venn (3) / Triple T-Chart — Compare THREE

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Comparing three people, groups, or ideas. Use the columns for each item and note shared traits in your notes.

Item A	Item B	Item C
Trait / criterion 1		
Trait / criterion 2		
Trait / criterion 3		
Trait / criterion 4		

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Two categories to sort or weigh: benefits vs costs, pros vs cons, before vs after, cause vs effect. Fast, low-floor entry point for comparison.

[illegible]

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Compare & Contrast Matrix — Items × Criteria

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Comparing several items across the SAME set of criteria. Reduces cognitive load by making the comparison systematic.

Criterion	Item 1	Item 2	Item 3

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Cause & Effect — Causal Chains

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Task asks “what caused...?”, “what were the effects/consequences of...?” Makes causal reasoning visible (builds SSP.05).

Cause	→	Effect
	→	
	→	
	→	
	→	

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Timeline / Sequence — Chronology

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Ordering events or tracing change over time. Builds chronological reasoning (SSP.05).

[illegible]

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

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Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Activating prior knowledge or showing how ideas relate to a central concept. Great as a pre-reading or review move.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Start of a standard: what students Know / Want to know; end: what they Learned. Builds metacognition and frames inquiry.

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

5 Ws — Cover the Basics of an Event

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Making sure students capture who/what/when/where/why of an event before analysis.

Question	Answer
Who?	
What?	
When?	
Where?	
Why?	

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Analyzing a problem and the responses to it (e.g., a policy or reform). Structures evaluation.

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Framer Model — Deep Vocabulary

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Learning a key term deeply (definition, characteristics, examples, non-examples).

Definition (own words)	Characteristics

Examples	Non-examples

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

CER — Build an Argument

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Any “make a claim / defend / argue” task. Claim + two pieces of evidence + reasoning (builds SSP.04).

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

HIPPO — Analyze a Primary Source

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Analyzing a photo, cartoon, map, or document (builds SSP.01–SSP.02). Pair with OPTIC for visuals.

H-I-P-P-O	Prompt / notes
H — Historical context	
I — Intended audience	
P — Purpose	
P — Point of view	
O — Outside connection	

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

★ Tennessee Connection — Local ↔ National

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Whenever a standard has a Tennessee tie: link the national event to our state/community and say why the local story matters. This local-to-national move is a HistoryHack signature — use it often.

[illegible]

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Part 2 — Cornell Support Backs (per standard, reproducible)

Guided and Light scaffolds for each standard's Cornell notes — moved here from the student workbook so you copy them only as needed (MTSS). Fade Guided → Light → independent as evidence grows.

US.01 — Homestead Act and Transcontinental Railroad: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
Homestead Act	An 1862 law that provided 160 acres of public land to settlers who agreed to live on and improve the land for five years, encouraging westward expansion.
Transcontinental Railroad	A continuous railroad line completed in 1869 that connected the eastern United States with the Pacific coast, revolutionizing transportation and commerce.
Eligible Claimants	Citizens, immigrants intending citizenship, women, and formerly enslaved people could claim land

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of homestead act and transcontinental railroad was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of homestead act and transcontinental railroad was Homestead Act: An 1862 law that provided 160 acres of public land to settlers who agreed to live on and improve the land for five years, encouraging westward expansion.

Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Homestead Act	_____ _____
Transcontinental Railroad	_____ _____

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Eligible Claimants	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “Sequence the expansion of the United States” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Impact on Western Settlement” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Impact on American Indians, Immigrants, and Settlers” section, and what evidence supports it?
- Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?
Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.

US.02 — Federal Policies Toward American Indians: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
Assimilation	Federal policy aimed at forcing Native Americans to abandon their traditional cultures and adopt European-American ways of life, including language, religion, and customs.
Dawes Act	An 1887 law that divided tribal lands into individual allotments for Native American families, aiming to break up reservations and assimilate Native Americans into mainstream American culture. It resulted in massive land loss.
Land Holdings (Bureau of Indian Affairs Records)	Native land holdings: 138 million acres (1887) → 48 million acres (1934)

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of federal policies toward american indians was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of federal policies toward american indians was Assimilation: Federal policy aimed at forcing Native Americans to abandon their traditional cultures and adopt European-American ways of life, including language, religion, and customs.

Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Assimilation	_____ _____
Dawes Act	_____ _____

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Land Holdings (Bureau of Indian Affairs Records)	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “Movement to Reservations” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - What is the main idea of the “Assimilation and Boarding Schools” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - What is the main idea of the “The Dawes Act and Its Impact” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?
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WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?
Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.

US.03 — Compromise of 1877, Jim Crow & Plessy v. Ferguson: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
Reconstruction	The period from 1865-1877 following the Civil War when the federal government worked to rebuild the South and integrate formerly enslaved people into American society as free citizens.
Exodusters	African Americans who migrated from the South to Kansas and other western states in the late 1870s, seeking to escape racial violence and economic oppression. Led by figures like Benjamin "Pap" Singleton.
Jim Crow Laws	State and local laws enacted primarily in the Southern states between 1877 and the 1960s that enforced racial segregation and denied African Americans their constitutional rights.

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of compromise of 1877, jim crow & plessy v. ferguson was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of compromise of 1877, jim crow & plessy v. ferguson was Reconstruction: The period from 1865-1877 following the Civil War when the federal government worked to rebuild the South and integrate formerly enslaved people into American society as free citizens.

Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — "This term means ..."
Reconstruction	_____ _____
Exodusters	_____

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Jim Crow Laws	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “The Election of 1876 and End of Reconstruction” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Jim Crow Laws, Lynching, and Disenfranchisement” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Pap Singleton and the Exodusters” section, and what evidence supports it?
- Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.

US.04 — Gilded Age Politics and Economics: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
Crédit Mobilier Scandal	A major 1872 corruption scandal involving the Union Pacific Railroad company overcharging the government for railroad construction and bribing congressmen to prevent investigation.
Interstate Commerce Act	An 1887 federal law that created the Interstate Commerce Commission to regulate railroad rates and practices, representing the first federal regulatory agency.
Gilded Age	The period from roughly 1870 to 1900 characterized by rapid economic growth, industrialization, and extreme wealth inequality. Named by Mark Twain to suggest that a thin layer of prosperity covered deep social problems.

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of gilded age politics and economics was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of gilded age politics and economics was Crédit Mobilier Scandal: A major 1872 corruption scandal involving the Union Pacific Railroad company overcharging the government for railroad construction and bribing congressmen to prevent investigation.

Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____ _____
Explain	_____ _____ _____
Headline	_____ _____ _____

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Crédit Mobilier Scandal	_____ _____
Interstate Commerce Act	_____

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Gilded Age	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “Political Machines and Boss Tweed” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - What is the main idea of the “Major Scandals and the Spoils System” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - What is the main idea of the “Civil Service Reform” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?
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WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.

US.05 — Inventions & Innovations of Business Leaders & Entrepreneurs: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
Vertical Integration	A business strategy where a company controls all stages of production, from raw materials to finished product, as practiced by Andrew Carnegie in the steel industry.
Horizontal Integration	A business strategy where a company buys out competitors in the same industry to reduce competition and control prices, as practiced by John D. Rockefeller in oil.

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of inventions & innovations of business leaders & entrepreneurs was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of inventions & innovations of business leaders & entrepreneurs was Vertical Integration: A business strategy where a company controls all stages of production, from raw materials to finished product, as practiced by Andrew Carnegie in the steel industry.

Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	
Evidence	
Explain	
Headline	

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Vertical Integration	
Horizontal Integration	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “Technological Innovations” section, and what evidence supports it?

- What is the main idea of the “Industrial Titans” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “African American Entrepreneurs” section, and what evidence supports it?
- Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.

US.06 — Industrial Centers and Urbanization: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
Urbanization	The rapid growth of cities due to industrialization and mass migration, transforming America from a predominantly rural to urban society.
Reconstruction	The period from 1865-1877 following the Civil War when the federal government worked to rebuild the South and integrate formerly enslaved people into American society as free citizens.

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of industrial centers and urbanization was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of industrial centers and urbanization was Urbanization: The rapid growth of cities due to industrialization and mass migration, transforming America from a predominantly rural to urban society.

Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____ _____
Explain	_____ _____ _____
Headline	_____ _____ _____

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Urbanization	_____ _____
Reconstruction	_____ _____ _____

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “Major Industrial Centers” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Rural-to-Urban Migration” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Geographic Factors in Industrial Location” section, and what evidence supports it?

- Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.

US.07 — Immigration: Old vs. New Immigrants: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
New Immigrants	Immigrants who came to the United States primarily from Southern and Eastern Europe (Italy, Poland, Russia) and Asia after 1880, often Catholic, Jewish, or Orthodox Christian, facing greater discrimination.
Ellis Island	The primary immigration processing station in New York Harbor from 1892 to 1954, where over 12 million immigrants entered the United States, primarily from Europe.
Angel Island	The immigration station in San Francisco Bay from 1910 to 1940 that primarily processed Asian immigrants, especially Chinese, who faced lengthy detentions and harsh interrogations.

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of immigration was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of immigration was New Immigrants: Immigrants who came to the United States primarily from Southern and Eastern Europe (Italy, Poland, Russia) and Asia after 1880, often Catholic, Jewish, or Orthodox Christian, facing greater discrimination.

Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
New Immigrants	_____ _____
Ellis Island	_____ _____
Angel Island	_____

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “Old and New Immigrants” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Entry Points and the Assimilation Process” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Push and Pull Factors” section, and what evidence supports it?
- Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?
Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.